

THE MUMFORD–TATE GROUP OF A VERY GENERAL LAGRANGIAN FIBER

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1. INTRODUCTION

Theorem 1.1 (=Corollary 4.11). *Let X be a primitive symplectic variety of dimension $2g$, and let $f : X \rightarrow B$ be a Lagrangian fibration. Let $\tilde{G}$ be the Mumford–Tate group of f .*

$$(1.1) \quad \tilde{G} = \begin{cases} (\mathbb{G}_m \times \mathrm{Sp}_{2g/k}^k)/\{\pm 1\} & : f \text{ varies maximally,} \\ \mathrm{GL}_2 & : f \text{ is isotrivial with Hodge-generic fiber,} \\ \mathbb{G}_m & : f \text{ is isotrivial with CM fiber.} \end{cases}$$

Theorem 1.2 (=Theorem 5.11). *Let $f : X \rightarrow B$ be a general member of a given deformation class of hyper-Kähler manifolds admitting a Lagrangian fibration (in the sense of Matsushita–Voisin***). Then the Mumford–Tate group of the very general fiber X_b is GSp_{2g} .*

1.1. The period matrix of a Lagrangian fibration. Our original motivation for this paper began with the following question of Valentino Tosatti, conveyed to us through Ben Bakker:

Question 1.3. *Let X be a hyper-Kähler manifold, $f : X \rightarrow B$ a Lagrangian fibration. Let $\mathcal{P} : B^\circ \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_g$ be its period map, with period matrix*

$$(1.2) \quad \mathcal{P}(b) = \begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{T}(b) \\ I_g \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{T} = \begin{pmatrix} \tau_{11} & \cdots & \tau_{1g} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \tau_{1g} & \cdots & \tau_{gg} \end{pmatrix}$$

Then the following are equivalent:

- (1) $\mathcal{P}$ is the constant map.
- (2) τ_{11} is constant.

While the statement seems ad hoc, if not outright false, Question 1.3 has a positive answer under the assumption that the very general fiber of f is Hodge-generic.

Proposition 1.4. *Suppose that the Mumford–Tate group of the very general fiber X_b is simple. If τ_{11} is constant, then $\mathcal{P}$ is the constant map.*

Proof. A result of Donagi–Markman [DM94] shows that the partial derivatives of the τ_{ij} obey a cubic symmetry condition: there exist $z_1, \dots, z_g$ local coordinates on B° for which

$$(1.3) \quad \frac{\partial \tau_{ij}}{\partial z_k} = \frac{\partial \tau_{ik}}{\partial z_j}, \quad 1 \leq i, j, k \leq g.$$

Thus, the condition that τ_{11} is constant in all directions implies that

$$\frac{\partial \tau_{11}}{\partial z_1} = \frac{\partial \tau_{12}}{\partial z_1} = \cdots = \frac{\partial \tau_{1g}}{\partial z_1} = 0.$$

Let V be the $\mathbb{Z}$ -VHS underlying f on the locus of smooth fibers B° . Choose a very general point $p \in B^\circ$, and let C_p be a (locally defined) complex curve given by integrating $\partial/\partial z_1$ through p . We get a real Hodge substructure

$$(1.4) \quad E = \begin{pmatrix} \tau_{11} \\ \tau_{21} \\ \vdots \\ \tau_{g1} \\ | \\ e_1 \\ | \end{pmatrix} \oplus \begin{pmatrix} \bar{\tau}_{11} \\ \bar{\tau}_{21} \\ \vdots \\ \bar{\tau}_{g1} \\ | \\ e_1 \\ | \end{pmatrix} \subseteq V_{\mathbb{R},p},$$

which is preserved by moving along C_p . In other words, E is contained in the fixed part of $V_{\mathbb{R}}|_{C_p}$.

We can interpret C_p more moduli-theoretically. Recall that we have $\mathcal{P} : B^\circ \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_g$; let $\tilde{\mathcal{P}} : U \rightarrow \mathbb{H}_g$ be a local lift of $\mathcal{P}$ to the universal cover of $\mathcal{A}_g$. Then $\tilde{\mathcal{P}}(U)$ meets the locus $\{E\} \times \mathbb{H}_{g-1}$ along the curve $\tilde{\mathcal{P}}(C_p)$. Observe that this is an atypical intersection: the image of $\tilde{\mathcal{P}}$ is g -dimensional, while the codimension of $\{E\} \times \mathbb{H}_{g-1}$ is also $\binom{g+1}{2} - \binom{g}{2} = g$, so the expected dimension of the intersection is $g - g = 0$. As a result, we can apply the functional transcendence result of Bakker–Tsimmerman [BT25, Theorem 1.3]: because $\tilde{\mathcal{P}}(U) \cap (\mathbb{H}_{g-1} \times \{E\})$ is atypical, $\mathcal{P}(C_p)$ is contained in a weakly special subvariety of $\mathcal{A}_g$.

However, recall that p was a very general point. Hence there is a weakly special subvariety $Z \subsetneq \mathcal{A}_g$ containing $\mathcal{P}(B^\circ)$. Such a subvariety necessarily arises from a normal subgroup H of the Mumford–Tate group $G = \text{MT}(Z)$ of the very general point of Z . But by assumption, G is simple. Since Z is strictly contained in $\mathcal{A}_g$, H is a strict normal subgroup of G which contains the Hodge torus, so that $H = \mathbb{G}_m$. Therefore $Z = \{\mathcal{P}(p)\}$, so that $\mathcal{P}$ is the constant map. $\square$

By applying Theorem 5.11, we now see that if X is a hyper-Kähler manifold chosen generally from its deformation class, the diagonal entries of its period matrix are not constant. However, knowing Corollary 4.11, we claim that Question 1.3 has a positive answer for all Lagrangian fibrations coming from any primitive symplectic variety X .

Theorem 1.5. *Let X be primitive symplectic, and $f : X \rightarrow B$ be a Lagrangian fibration with period map $\mathcal{P} : B^\circ \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_g$ and period matrix $\mathbf{T}$. Suppose there exists a vector $\mathbf{v}$ for which the function*

$$\mathbf{v}^T \mathbf{T} \mathbf{v} : B^\circ \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_g$$

is constant in an analytic neighborhood $U \subseteq B^\circ$. Then f is isotrivial.

Proof. *** $\square$

2. PRELIMINARIES

2.1. Lagrangian fibrations coming from primitive symplectic varieties. We begin with the relevant definitions of symplectic varieties which appear in this paper.

Definition 2.1. Let X and B be normal analytic varieties, and $f : X \rightarrow B$ a non-trivial surjective morphism with connected fibers.

- (1) We say that X is **holomorphic symplectic** if it admits a non-degenerate 2-form $\sigma \in H^0(X^{\text{sm}}, \Omega_{X^{\text{sm}}}^2)$ which extends holomorphically onto a resolution of singularities $Y \rightarrow X$.
- (2) We say that a subvariety $Z \subseteq X$ is **Lagrangian** if $\sigma|_Z = 0$ and $\dim Z = \frac{1}{2} \dim X$. We say that $f : X \rightarrow B$ is a Lagrangian fibration if every fiber of f is Lagrangian.
- (3) Suppose that X is compact, $\mathbb{Q}$ -factorial, and log-terminal. We say that X is **primitive symplectic** if $H^1(X, \mathcal{O}_X) = 0$ and the symplectic form σ is unique up to scaling.
- (4) If X is compact, smooth, and simply connected with a symplectic form σ unique up to scaling, we say that X is **hyper-Kähler**.

By the Beauville–Bogomolov decomposition theorem, any smooth compact symplectic variety is isogenous to a product of hyper-Kähler manifolds and complex tori. Their work has more recently been generalized to compact symplectic varieties, which are isogenous to products of complex tori and special classes of primitive symplectic varieties (see, for instance, [HP19, Theorem 1.5]).

***Deformation/moduli theory?

When X is hyper-Kähler, much is understood. For instance, any non-trivial surjective morphism $f : X \rightarrow B$ with connected fibers is Lagrangian, and B is smooth if and only if $B \simeq \mathbb{P}^n$ [GL14]. A conjecture of Matsushita predicts that this is always the case.

More generally, suppose X is any primitive symplectic variety admitting a Lagrangian fibration $f : X \rightarrow B$. We abuse notation to denote $f : X^\circ \rightarrow B^\circ$ the restriction of f to the preimage of the regular values, over which the fibers of f are smooth. It turns out that every smooth fiber X_b is an Abelian variety, due to Matsushita [Mat99] when X is projective hyper-Kähler and [Cam06] in more general settings.

Take X to have dimension $2g$, so that both the base B and the fibers X_b are g -dimensional. We denote by $\mathcal{P} : B^\circ \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_{g,\eta}$ the period map associated to f , where $\mathcal{A}_{g,\eta}$ is a moduli space for appropriately-polarized Abelian varieties. If $\mathcal{P}$ is non-constant, i.e. f is not an isotrivial fibration, then $\mathcal{P}$ is generically injective; this is due to [GV16] for X a very general hyper-Kähler and [Bak25] for primitive symplectic X . In the non-isotrivial case, we say that f varies maximally.

2.2. Deligne’s canonical extension. Let $f : X \rightarrow B$ be a family of Abelian varieties, $D \subseteq B$ the discriminant locus of f , $B^\circ = B \setminus D$, and $f : X^\circ \rightarrow B^\circ$ the smooth part of f , as above. We may consider the underlying $\mathbb{Z}$ -variation of Hodge structures $V = R^1 f_* \mathbb{Z}_{X^\circ}$. Let $\mathcal{V} = V \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathcal{O}_{B^\circ}$ be the underlying flat bundle, equipped with the flat connection $\nabla : \mathcal{V} \rightarrow \mathcal{V} \otimes \Omega_{B^\circ}^1$.

Extending $\mathcal{V}$ to all of B as a flat bundle is impractical, since the VHS degenerates along D . However, Deligne constructs a vector bundle $\bar{\mathcal{V}}$ extending $\mathcal{V}$ to D^{ls} the log-smooth part of D , along with a logarithmic connection

$$\bar{\nabla} : \bar{\mathcal{V}} \rightarrow \bar{\mathcal{V}} \otimes \Omega_{B^{\text{ls}}}^1(\log D^{\text{ls}})$$

extending ∇ . We will outline the local construction of $\bar{\mathcal{V}}$ on the smooth part of the discriminant D^{sm} ; this will be enough for the purposes of this paper, but the general case of D^{ls} is completely analogous, albeit with more variables.

Let $U \simeq \Delta^g \subseteq B^\circ$ be a polydisk which only meets $D^{\text{sm}} \subseteq D$, and let $U^\circ \simeq \Delta^* \times \Delta^{g-1}$ be the complement of the discriminant in U . Denote the restriction of $\mathcal{V}$ to U° by $\mathcal{V}_U$. The monodromy group of the restricted VHS is generated by a single element, which we will

denote by $T \in \text{Aut}(V_b)$ for some $b \in U^\circ$. Let $t_1, t_2, \dots, t_g$ be the natural coordinates on U , so that U° is defined by the non-vanishing of t_1 .

By the classical Monodromy Theorem, T is quasi-unipotent, so that we can write $T = T_s \cdot T_u$, where $T_s^m = I_g$ and T_u is unipotent. In particular, T admits a formal logarithm

$$N = \log T = \log T_s + \log T_u = N_s + N_u,$$

where N_u is nilpotent, uniquely defined by

$$N_u = (T_u - I_g) - \frac{1}{2}(T_u - I_g)^2 + \dots$$

and N_s is a matrix satisfying the property

$$\exp(-2\pi i N_s) = T_s.$$

Since N_s is produced by diagonalizing T_s and applying $z \mapsto \frac{\log z}{2\pi i}$, it depends only on a choice of logarithm branch cut. As such, N_s is unique upon choosing a half-open unit interval $I \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ in which the eigenvalues of N_s lie. We construct sections for the bundle $\overline{\mathcal{V}}_U$ as follows.

Let $v = v(t_1, t_2, \dots, t_g) \in V_{\mathbb{C}}|_U \subseteq \mathcal{V}_U$ be a flat multi-section of $\mathcal{V}_U$, i.e. a multi-section of the underlying $\mathbb{C}$ -local system $V_{\mathbb{C}}|_U$. We allow it to be multivalued because moving around D sends v to $T.v$. Define

$$\tilde{v}(t_1, t_2, \dots, t_g) = \exp\left(\frac{\log(t_1)N}{2\pi i}\right) \cdot v(t_1, \dots, t_g).$$

It is not hard to see that this new section is single-valued on U° , and one readily checks that $\tilde{v}$ has a removable singularity along D . For a detailed overview, refer to refer to [Cat16].

Finally, for a frame of flat multisections $v_1, \dots, v_r \in \mathcal{V}_U$, we define the canonical extension $\overline{\mathcal{V}}_U = \bigoplus_{i=1}^r \mathcal{O}_U \tilde{v}_i$. It comes with an induced logarithmic connection

$$\nabla : \tilde{v}_j \mapsto \nabla \left(\exp\left(\frac{\log(t_1)N}{2\pi i}\right) \cdot v_j \right) = \frac{N}{2\pi i} \tilde{v}_j \otimes \frac{dz}{z}.$$

It is a highly non-trivial, but nevertheless true fact that this construction globalizes to all of B^{ls} , i.e. one glues $\overline{\mathcal{V}}_U$ along all the analytic neighborhoods U of D^{ls} the log-smooth locus of the discriminant to canonically produce an extension $\overline{\mathcal{V}}$ of $\mathcal{V}$

Next, we turn our attention to the special case where V is a variation of Hodge structures coming from a Lagrangian fibration $f : X \rightarrow B$. In this setting, we can describe Deligne's canonical extension in another way. Generalizing a result of Matsushita, Schnell [Sch23, §4] proves that the natural isomorphism

$$\iota_\sigma : \mathcal{T}_{B^\circ} \xrightarrow{\sim} F^1 \mathcal{V}, \quad w \mapsto \sigma(w, -)$$

extends to an isomorphism

$$\iota_\sigma : \mathcal{T}_{B^{\text{ls}}} \xrightarrow{\sim} F^1 \overline{\mathcal{V}},$$

where $F^1 \overline{\mathcal{V}} := \overline{\mathcal{V}} \cap j_*(F^1 \mathcal{V})$, and $\overline{\mathcal{V}}$ is Deligne's canonical extension for which N_s has eigenvalues in $(-1, 0]$. Since the locus of D which fails to be log-smooth has codimension at least 2 in B , we may further reflexivize both sheaves to produce an isomorphism $\mathcal{T}_B \simeq (F^1 \overline{\mathcal{V}})^{\vee\vee}$; in abuse of notation, we will often drop the reflexivization on the right.

2.3. Mumford–Tate groups of weight one Hodge structures. Recall that the Deligne torus is the real algebraic group $\mathbb{S} = \text{Res}_{\mathbb{C}/\mathbb{R}} \mathbb{G}_{m,\mathbb{C}}$; the data of a weight one $\mathbb{Q}$ -Hodge structure is the data of a vector space $H_{\mathbb{Q}}$ together with a representation $h : \mathbb{S} \rightarrow \text{GL}(H_{\mathbb{R}})$ such that the underlying weight representation

$$\mathbb{G}_{m,\mathbb{R}} \xrightarrow{w} \mathbb{S} \xrightarrow{h} \text{GL}(H_{\mathbb{R}})$$

is defined over $\mathbb{Q}$.

Definition 2.2. The **Mumford–Tate group** of a $\mathbb{Q}$ -Hodge structure $H_{\mathbb{Q}}$ is the smallest algebraic subgroup $G \subseteq \text{GL}(H_{\mathbb{Q}})$ whose real points contain the image of h .

For a brief introduction to Mumford–Tate groups and Mumford–Tate domains, we recommend [CMSP17, Chapter 15]. However, we will summarize the necessary basic results below.

If V is a $\mathbb{Q}$ -VHS on a quasi-projective variety B° , there is a countable collection $\{Z_j\}$ of closed subvarieties of B° such that for any $b, b' \in B^{\circ} \setminus \bigcup_{j=1}^{\infty} Z_j$ we have $\mathbf{MT}(V_b) = \mathbf{MT}(V_{b'})$. For this reason, we will abuse notation and write $\mathbf{MT}(V)$ to denote the Mumford–Tate group of the Hodge structure V_b over the very general point $b \in B^{\circ}$.

We note that if $Z \subseteq B^{\circ}$ is a closed subvariety, then $\mathbf{MT}(V|_Z) \leq \mathbf{MT}(V)$. A weight one polarized VHS admits a period map to a period domain $\mathcal{P} : B^{\circ} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_{g,\eta}$. Since the Mumford–Tate group only shrinks under specialization, we can make the following definition.

Definition 2.3. Let H be a weight one polarized $\mathbb{Q}$ -Hodge structure. We say that H is **Hodge-generic** if H has a maximal Mumford–Tate group in $\mathcal{A}_{g,\eta}$, i.e. $\mathbf{MT}(H) = \text{GSp}_{2g,\mathbb{Q}}$.

Notice that the VHS V naturally gives rise to two representations: the Mumford–Tate group $\mathbf{MT}(V_b)$ and the fundamental group $\pi_1(B^{\circ}, b)$ both act on the very general fiber V_b . One can ask if these two representations are related. A theorem of Yves André provides an affirmative answer.

Theorem 2.4 (André). *Let V be a polarized $\mathbb{Q}$ -VHS on a quasi-projective variety B° , and let $\rho : \pi_1(B^{\circ}, b) \rightarrow \text{GL}(V_b)$ be the monodromy action on a very general fiber. Take M to be the Zariski closure of the monodromy group $\text{im}(\rho) \leq \text{GL}(V_b)$, and let $M^{\circ} \leq M$ be its identity component. Then*

$$M^{\circ} \leq [\mathbf{MT}(V_b), \mathbf{MT}(V_b)].$$

On the other hand, the group $\mathbf{MT}(V_b)$ admits an action on $\mathcal{A}_{g,\eta}$. We refer to the orbit of V_b under this action as a Mumford–Tate subdomain. It can be shown that this orbit is a Hermitian locally symmetric submanifold. Consequently, the groups which can occur as $\mathbf{MT}(V_b)$ are highly constrained. Due to work of Satake [Sat67], we have a full classification of the group $\mathbf{MT}(V_b)$ and its action on V_b , up to a central isogeny. These groups are presented in Table 1, along with some useful associated invariants.

2.4. Clifford theory.

3. GENERAL SINGULAR FIBERS IN A LAGRANGIAN FIBRATION

For this section, we work with local analytic Lagrangian degenerations. To that end, let $U \simeq \Delta^g$ be a polydisk, $D \subseteq U$ an irreducible codimension one subvariety such that $U^{\circ} := U \setminus D \simeq \Delta^{g-1} \times \Delta^*$.

Real group (up to isogeny)	Dimension of Mumford–Tate subdomain	Dimension of representation
$\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$	1	2
$\mathrm{SU}(p, n-p)$	$p(n-p)$	n
$\mathrm{SU}(1, n-1)$	$n-1$	$\binom{n}{c}$ $c \in \{2, 3, \dots, n-2\}$
$\mathrm{SO}^*(2r)$	$\binom{r}{2}$	$2r$
$\mathrm{Sp}(r)$	$\binom{r+1}{2}$	$2r$
$\mathrm{SO}(2p-2, 2)$	$2p-2$	2^{p-1}
$\mathrm{SO}(2p-1, 2)$	$2p-1$	2^p

TABLE 1. Satake’s classification of real forms of irreducible weight one Mumford–Tate representations.

Let (X, σ) be a holomorphic symplectic manifold of dimension $2g$ equipped with a proper surjective morphism $f : X \rightarrow U$, such that X_b is Lagrangian for all $b \in U$, and X_b is smooth for $b \in U^\circ$ and singular when $b \in D$. Let X° be the preimage of U° in X . Set $V = R^1 f_* \mathbb{Z}_{X^\circ}$ to be the variation of Hodge structures underlying f . Finally, let $T \in \mathrm{Sp}_{2g}(\mathbb{Z})$ be a generator for the monodromy group of f acting on the cohomology of a general fiber X_b .

Lemma 3.1 ([BS26], Lemma 6.6). *T has at most two non-trivial eigenvalues $\zeta_i, \bar{\zeta}_i$, which are the primitive i -th roots of unity for an integer i dividing six. If T has infinite order, i divides two.*

Proof. Let $N = \log T = N^{ss} + N^u$. Deligne’s canonical extension extends a local frame $v_1, \dots, v_{2g} \in H^0(U^\circ, \mathcal{V})$ to a frame $\tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_{2g} \in H^0(U, \bar{\mathcal{V}})$, $\tilde{v}_j = \exp(\frac{zN}{2\pi i}).v_j$, for z a local coordinate on the universal cover of U° . We can choose the v_j in such a way that N has the form

$$N = \begin{pmatrix} D & S \\ 0 & D' \end{pmatrix}, \quad S = \begin{pmatrix} I_g & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

This frame has the advantage that it behaves well with respect to the flat connection: if we set φ to be the local defining equation of D ,

$$\nabla \tilde{v}_k = \frac{N(\tilde{v}_k)}{2\pi i} \frac{d\varphi}{\varphi} = \frac{\alpha_k}{2\pi i} \frac{d\varphi}{\varphi} \tilde{v}_k + \frac{\beta_k}{2\pi i} \frac{d\varphi}{\varphi} \tilde{v}_{g+k}.$$

The limit mixed Hodge structures of $\mathcal{V}$ define a locally split sub-bundle $\langle \tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_g \rangle|_D \subseteq \bar{\mathcal{V}}|_D$. After possibly shrinking the open subset U , we may lift this to a Deligne frame $h_1, \dots, h_g, h_{g+1}, \dots, h_{2g} \in H^0(U, \bar{\mathcal{V}})$,

$$F^1 \bar{\mathcal{V}} = \langle h_1, \dots, h_g \rangle \subseteq \bar{\mathcal{V}},$$

agreeing with $\langle \tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_g \rangle$ on D .

Now we have two exact sequences

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \langle \tilde{v}_{g+1}, \dots, \tilde{v}_{2g} \rangle & \longrightarrow & \bar{\mathcal{V}} & \longrightarrow & \bar{\mathcal{V}} / \langle \tilde{v}_{g+1}, \dots, \tilde{v}_{2g} \rangle \\ \parallel & & \parallel & & \downarrow g \\ \langle \tilde{v}_{g+1}, \dots, \tilde{v}_{2g} \rangle & \longrightarrow & \bar{\mathcal{V}} & \longrightarrow & \bar{\mathcal{V}} / \langle h_{g+1}, \dots, h_{2g} \rangle \end{array}$$

Thus the two splittings differ by an element of $\text{Hom}(\bar{\mathcal{V}} / \langle \tilde{v}_{g+1}, \dots, \tilde{v}_{2g} \rangle, \langle \tilde{v}_{g+1}, \dots, \tilde{v}_{2g} \rangle)$. In other words, the isomorphism g has the form

$$h_j = \tilde{v}_j + \sum_{k=g+1}^{2g} g_{jk} \tilde{v}_k, \quad j = 1, \dots, g.$$

Recall from [BS26] and our summary above the isomorphism $\mathcal{T}_U \simeq F^1 \bar{\mathcal{V}} = \langle h_1, \dots, h_g \rangle$. This isomorphism is compatible with Lie bracket, so we have

$$\begin{aligned} [h_j, h_k] &= \nabla_{h_j} \tilde{v}_k - \nabla_{h_k} \tilde{v}_j + \sum_{\ell=g+1}^{2g} h_j(g_{k\ell}) \tilde{v}_\ell + g_{k\ell} \nabla_{h_j} \tilde{v}_\ell - h_k(g_{j\ell}) \tilde{v}_\ell - g_{j\ell} \nabla_{h_k} \tilde{v}_\ell \\ &= \frac{\alpha_k}{2\pi i} \frac{d\varphi(h_j)}{\varphi} \tilde{v}_k - \frac{\alpha_j}{2\pi i} \frac{d\varphi(h_k)}{\varphi} \tilde{v}_j + \frac{\beta_k}{2\pi i} \frac{d\varphi(h_j)}{\varphi} \tilde{v}_{g+k} - \frac{\beta_j}{2\pi i} \frac{d\varphi(h_k)}{\varphi} \tilde{v}_{g+j} + \\ &\quad + \sum_{\ell=g+1}^{2g} \left(h_j(g_{k\ell}) - h_k(g_{j\ell}) + \frac{\alpha_\ell}{2\pi i} \left(g_{k\ell} \frac{d\varphi(h_j)}{\varphi} - g_{j\ell} \frac{d\varphi(h_k)}{\varphi} \right) \right) \tilde{v}_\ell \\ &= \frac{\alpha_k}{2\pi i} \frac{d\varphi(h_j)}{\varphi} h_k - \frac{\alpha_j}{2\pi i} \frac{d\varphi(h_k)}{\varphi} h_j + \frac{\beta_k}{2\pi i} \frac{d\varphi(h_j)}{\varphi} \tilde{v}_{g+k} - \frac{\beta_j}{2\pi i} \frac{d\varphi(h_j)}{\varphi} \tilde{v}_{g+j} + \\ &\quad + \sum_{\ell=g+1}^{2g} \left(g_{j\ell} - g_{k\ell} + h_j(g_{k\ell}) - h_k(g_{j\ell}) + \frac{\alpha_\ell}{2\pi i} \left(g_{k\ell} \frac{d\varphi(h_j)}{\varphi} - g_{j\ell} \frac{d\varphi(h_k)}{\varphi} \right) \right) \tilde{v}_\ell \\ &= \frac{\alpha_k}{2\pi i} \frac{d\varphi(h_j)}{\varphi} h_k - \frac{\alpha_j}{2\pi i} \frac{d\varphi(h_k)}{\varphi} h_j. \end{aligned}$$

The last equality follows from the fact that the $\tilde{v}_\ell$ are not contained in $\mathcal{T}_U$ when $\ell \geq g+1$.

Now, for $[h_j, h_k]$ to be holomorphic, we need either $\alpha_k = 0$ or φ divides $d\varphi(h_j)$. The latter is equivalent to h_j being tangent to D . But D is of codimension one, so at least one of the h_j is not tangent to D , say h_λ . This forces $\alpha_k = 0$ for all $k \neq \lambda$.

Notice additionally that g_{jk} all vanish on D . Thus, when restricting to D , the higher $\tilde{v}_\ell$ terms in the expression above yield

$$0 = \frac{\beta_k}{2\pi i} \frac{d\varphi(h_j)}{\varphi} \tilde{v}_{g+k} - \frac{\beta_j}{2\pi i} \frac{d\varphi(h_k)}{\varphi} \tilde{v}_{g+j} + \sum_{\ell=g+1}^{2g} (h_j(g_{k\ell}) - h_k(g_{j\ell})) \tilde{v}_\ell$$

The sum on the right is holomorphic along D , and φ does not divide $d\varphi(h_\lambda)$. Hence $\beta_k = 0$ for all $k \neq \lambda$. Hence we may lose no generality in writing that $\lambda = 1$, i.e. the only possibly non-trivial eigenvalues are α_1 and the only possibly non-semisimple eigenvector is $\tilde{v}_1$.

Observe that T is now an integer matrix with at most two non-trivial eigenvalues. By Grothendieck, all eigenvalues of T are roots of unity; if ζ_i is a primitive i -th root of unity, all other primitive i -th roots of unity are in its Galois orbit, and thus also occur as eigenvalues of T . Thus if ϕ is Euler's totient function, we must have $\phi(i) \leq 2$. This forces $i = 1, 2, 3, 4$, or 6 . Furthermore, when T has infinite order, there is only one non-trivial Jordan block, forcing $\zeta_i = \bar{\zeta}_i$, or equivalently $\zeta_i = \pm 1$. $\square$

4. CLASSIFICATION OF LAGRANGIAN MUMFORD–TATE GROUPS

4.1. Existence of infinite local monodromy. Now we work in the compact setting. Let X be a primitive symplectic variety of dimension $2g$ which admits a maximally varying Lagrangian fibration $f : X \rightarrow B$. Take V to be the underlying variation of Hodge structures on B° .

Proposition 4.1. *There exists an analytic neighborhood $U \simeq \Delta^g \subseteq B$ meeting the discriminant $D \subseteq B$ in a codimension one subvariety $D_U := D \cap U \subseteq U$, such that the local monodromy of f around D_U is infinite.*

Before proving this proposition, we remark on an important consequence. For one, recall from Hwang–Oguiso [HO09] that $D \subseteq B$ is either empty or codimension one. In the case where X is primitive symplectic, we can rule out the former case entirely.

Corollary 4.2. *Let X be a primitive symplectic variety, and let $f : X \rightarrow B$ be a Lagrangian fibration. Then the discriminant locus $D \subseteq B$ of f has codimension one.*

Proof. Since X is primitive symplectic, f is either maximally varying or isotrivial. By Proposition 4.1, the discriminant of f has a codimension one component whenever f varies maximally, so we may take f to be isotrivial. Now if $D = \emptyset$, f is the trivial fibration and $X \simeq X_b \times B$. But by Kunneth, we must now have $H^1(X, \mathbb{C}) \neq 0$, a contradiction. $\square$

Proof of Proposition 4.1. Since $V_{\mathbb{Q}}$ is irreducible, the period image lands in an indecomposable special subvariety of $\mathcal{A}_{g,\eta}$. By [GMMT25, Theorem 4.5], the g -dimensional period image is not Hodge-generic inside of any special indecomposable non-compact subvariety. Thus we only need to show that the period image is not contained in a compact special subvariety.

Let $G = [\mathbf{MT}(V_{\mathbb{Q}}), \mathbf{MT}(V_{\mathbb{Q}})]$ be a $\mathbb{Q}$ -simple factor of the derived Mumford–Tate group. By the classical theorem [GMMT25, Corollary 2.7], we can write $G = \text{Res}_{K/\mathbb{Q}} H$, for K a totally real field and H a geometrically simple K -algebraic group. (***)Why can we take factors of DMT without losing generality?)

By [BT65, Corollary 8.5], an algebraic group over a number field is anisotropic (contains no positive-dimensional split tori) if and only if it contains no non-trivial unipotent elements. By Schmid's nilpotent orbit theorem, for G this is equivalent to defining a compact special

subvariety in $\mathcal{A}_{g,\eta}$. Note that G is anisotropic if and only if H is anisotropic, since a unipotent element of one induces a unipotent element of the other.

We will prove that H is not anisotropic. This will show that the image of the period map is not contained in a compact special subvariety. To do this, we will apply the results of [Sch85].

Lemma 4.3 ([GMMT25], §5.1). *Suppose that $H = \text{Aut}(U, \eta)^{\text{ad}}$ is non-compact at all real places. Assume that one of the following conditions holds:*

- (q) U is a K -vector space, η is symmetric bilinear, and $\dim_K U \geq 5$.
- (uF) U is an L -vector space for L/K a quadratic extension with involution $*$, η is a $*$ -hermitian form, and $\dim_L U \geq 3$.
- (uH) U is a right $\mathbb{H}$ -module for $\mathbb{H}/K$ a quaternion division algebra with involution $*$, η is a $*$ -hermitian form, and $\dim_{\mathbb{H}} U \geq 2$.
- (uD) U is a right $\mathbb{D}$ -module, for $\mathbb{D}$ a non-commutative division algebra over L a quadratic extension of K with involution $*$, η is a $*$ -hermitian form, and $\dim_{\mathbb{D}} V \geq 3$.
- (skH) U is a right $\mathbb{H}$ -module, for $\mathbb{H}$ a quaternion division algebra over K with canonical involution $*$, η is a skew-hermitian form, and $\dim_{\mathbb{H}} U \geq 4$.

Then H is anisotropic.

In our setting, V varies maximally, so H must be non-compact at all real places. Thus we may rule out all cases one-by-one. We follow the exact analysis of [GMMT25, §7.2]. Satake classified all possible real forms of H up to isogeny, and we analyze each case. Let S denote the special subvariety associated to G .

H has type A_1 : We must have $H = \text{Nm}(\mathbb{H})$ and $\dim U_i = 2$ for all i . Write $\dim V = 2g = k \dim U_i = 2kh$. If $k = 1$, $H = \text{SL}_{2,K}$ is not anisotropic. Otherwise, $g \leq \dim S = \frac{g}{h}$ yields a contradiction.

H has type D_4 : $(U_i)_{\mathbb{C}}$ is a standard orthogonal representation of dimension $h = 8$. Since U_i is not symplectic, its dual must also occur in the decomposition of V , so $\dim V = 16k$, while $\dim S = 6$. Thus $g = 8k \leq 6$, a contradiction.

H has type I : We are in (uF) and (uD) of Lemma 4.3, so $H = \text{SU}(\mathbb{D}^r, \eta)$ with $r \leq 2$ and $\dim_K U_i \leq 4$. Here $\mathbb{D}$ has degree $\delta \geq 2$ over a CM extension L/K . We may identify $(U_i)_{\mathbb{C}} \simeq M_{\delta \times \delta}(\mathbb{C})^{\oplus r}$ as $H(\mathbb{C})$ -representations. Moreover, U_i is not self-dual, so its dual occurs in the decomposition of $V_{\mathbb{C}}$. In particular,

$$\dim V = 2g = 2k \dim U_i = 2k\delta^2 r.$$

On the other hand, $\dim S$ is maximized when the signature of $H(\mathbb{C})$ is $(\frac{r\delta}{2}, \frac{r\delta}{2})$. Even in this case,

$$g = k\delta^2 r \leq \dim S \leq k \cdot \frac{\delta r}{2} \cdot \frac{\delta r}{2} = \frac{1}{4}k\delta^2 r^2,$$

so that $r \geq 4$, a contradiction.

H has type I' : H is the same as in type I , and $U \simeq \bigwedge^c \mathbb{C}^{r\delta}$. Now $\dim U_i = \binom{r\delta}{c}$, while $\dim S = r\delta - 1$. Since U_i is not self-dual, we cannot have $g \leq \dim S$ even when $c = 1$.

H has type II : Here $G = \text{SU}(\mathbb{H}^r, \eta)$ with $r \geq 2$ and η skew-hermitian. We are in the case (skH) of Lemma 4.3, so $2 \leq \dim_{\mathbb{H}} U_i \leq 3$. Note again that U_i is not self-dual, so that its dual also occurs in the decomposition of $V_{\mathbb{C}}$. Thus $\dim V = 2g = 2k \dim U_i = 4kr$. On the other hand, $\dim S = k \frac{r(r-1)}{2}$. Thus $g = 2kr \leq k \frac{r(r-1)}{2}$, so that $4 \leq r - 1$, a contradiction.

H has type III: There are two possibilities here. Either $H = \mathrm{Sp}(K^{2r}, \eta)$, or $H = \mathrm{SU}(\mathbb{H}^r, \eta')$. The former case is always anisotropic, so we need not consider it. When $r \geq 2$, we are in case (uH) of Lemma 4.3, so S is non-compact. When $r = 1$, H has type A_1 , which we have already disproved.

H has type IV: H must be a form of $\mathrm{SO}_n^{\mathrm{ad}}$, for $n \geq 5$. This puts us into the cases (q) and (skH) of Lemma 4.3. In either case, H is anisotropic.

□

4.2. Splitting the monodromy group also splits the representation. Let S be the special Mumford–Tate group of $V_{\mathbb{Q}}$, and let $\Lambda = \mathrm{im}(\rho : \pi_1(B^\circ, b) \rightarrow \mathrm{Sp}_{2g, \mathbb{Q}})$. Define its Zariski closure $\mathrm{Mon}(V_{\mathbb{Q}}) = \overline{\Lambda}$; it admits an exact sequence

$$1 \rightarrow \mathrm{Mon}(V_{\mathbb{Q}})^\circ \rightarrow \mathrm{Mon}(V_{\mathbb{Q}}) \rightarrow \Gamma \rightarrow 1,$$

where Γ is the component group of $\mathrm{Mon}(V_{\mathbb{Q}})$. By André, $\mathrm{Mon}(V_{\mathbb{Q}})^\circ$ is a normal subgroup of S .

Lemma 4.4. *There exists a branched Galois cover of normal projective varieties $\pi : B' \rightarrow B$ such that $\mathrm{Mon}(\pi^*V_{\mathbb{Q}}) = \mathrm{Mon}(V_{\mathbb{Q}})^\circ$.*

Proof. Construct $\pi : B'^\circ \rightarrow B^\circ$ as follows: let Λ° be the preimage of $\mathrm{Mon}(V_{\mathbb{Q}})^\circ$ under the natural inclusion. It is the preimage of a normal subgroup, and is therefore normal in Λ . We have an exact sequence

$$1 \rightarrow \Lambda^\circ \rightarrow \Lambda \rightarrow \Gamma \rightarrow 1.$$

Define B'° to be the étale cover corresponding to the surjection $\Lambda \rightarrow \Gamma$, i.e. $\Lambda^\circ = \pi_1(B'^\circ, b')$. Because Λ° is normal in Λ , the cover is Galois. Now we may define B'° to be the normalization of B'° in the function field $K(B)$. □

To understand the monodromy of $\pi^*V_{\mathbb{Q}}$, we will use André’s theorem, which implies that $\mathrm{Mon}(V_{\mathbb{Q}})^\circ \trianglelefteq S$. The remainder of this section will be dedicated to understanding the action of S on $V_{\mathbb{Q}}$.

Proposition 4.5. *There exists an isomorphism of $\mathbb{C}$ -Hodge structures $\pi^*V_{\mathbb{C}} = U_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus U_k$, where U_i has the compatible structure of an irreducible $\mathfrak{h}_i$ -representation and $\mathfrak{h}_j$ acts trivially on U_i for $j \neq i$.*

Proof. We have an isomorphism of complex Lie algebras $\mathfrak{s}_{\mathbb{C}} = \mathfrak{h}_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus \mathfrak{h}_k$ coming from the isogeny decomposition. In particular, the decomposed Lie algebra acts on $V_{\mathbb{C}}$ by

$$d\rho : \mathfrak{h}_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus \mathfrak{h}_k \rightarrow \mathrm{Aut}(V_{\mathbb{C}}).$$

Let U be an irreducible factor of $\pi^*V_{\mathbb{C}}$; we can write it as a tensor product $U = W_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes W_k$, where W_i is an irreducible $\mathfrak{h}_i$ -representation.

Let $\mu : \mathbb{G}_{m, \mathbb{C}} \rightarrow S(\mathbb{C})$ be the Hodge cocharacter. Since $V_{\mathbb{Q}}$ is weight 1, $\mu(z)$ acts by z or 0. Consequently, $d\mu : \mathbb{C} \rightarrow \mathfrak{s}_{\mathbb{C}} \rightarrow \mathrm{Aut}(V_{\mathbb{C}})$ acts by matrices with eigenvalues in $\{0, 1\}$. Denote by $\mu_i : \mathbb{C} \rightarrow \mathfrak{h}_i \rightarrow \mathrm{Aut}(W_i)$ the projection to the i -th factor. Suppose for $z \in \mathbb{C}$ and $w_i \in W_i$ we have $d\mu(z).w_i = w_i$; then

$$d\mu(z).(w_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes w_k) = (\lambda_1 + \cdots + \lambda_k).(w_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes w_k),$$

where λ_j are the eigenvalues of $d\mu(z)$ acting on W_j . Since $\lambda_i = 1$ and $\lambda_1 + \cdots + \lambda_k \in \{0, 1\}$, we must have $\lambda_j = 0$ for all $j \neq i$.

Lemma 4.6. $\mathfrak{h}_j$ acts trivially on W_j for $j \neq i$.

Proof. S is the smallest $\mathbb{Q}$ -algebraic group whose real points contain the image of the Hodge cocharacter. As such, if $X \in \mathfrak{s}_{\mathbb{C}}$ is a generator of the image of $d\mu$, its projection to $\mathfrak{h}_j$ must be $X_j \neq 0$ for all $j = 1, \dots, k$. Furthermore, $\mathfrak{h}_j$ is simple for all j , so that $[\mathfrak{h}_j, \mathfrak{h}_j] = \mathfrak{h}_j$. In particular, X_j is traceless on W_j .

Now if W_j is non-trivial, X_j must have at least one positive integer eigenvalue and at least one negative integer eigenvalue. Let $\lambda_j \geq 1$ be the largest eigenvalue of X_j acting on W_j . By the same argument, $\lambda_i \geq 1$. This forces X to have an eigenvalue of at least two on U , a contradiction. Thus the image of the Deligne torus X_j acts trivially on W_j for $j \neq i$.

Note that we have not yet shown that $\mathfrak{h}_j$ acts trivially, only that the representation W_j has level zero. Indeed, one may consider Mumford’s famous example of a non-trivial family of Abelian 4-folds with Mumford–Tate group isogenous to $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R}) \times \mathrm{SU}(2)^2$ [Mum69]. To rule out such examples, we will need to leverage some actual geometry native to Lagrangian fibrations.

Let $D_1 \subseteq B$ be a component of the discriminant with infinite local monodromy; such a component exists by Proposition 4.1. Let T be a local monodromy operator for this component; its logarithm N belongs to $\mathfrak{h}_1 \oplus \dots \oplus \mathfrak{h}_k$. Since $\mathfrak{h}_i$ acts with level one on W_i , we may choose T such that the projection $N_i \in \mathfrak{h}_i$ acts non-trivially. By Lemma 3.1, N has rank one, so that all other projections $N_j = 0$, for $j \neq i$.

Now observe that every other W_j is forced to be one-dimensional. Indeed, suppose $\dim W_1 \geq 2$; then for every basis vector $w_{1,\alpha} \in W_1$,

$$N.(w_{1,\alpha} \otimes \dots \otimes w_i \otimes \dots \otimes w_k) = w_{1,\alpha} \otimes \dots \otimes N_i.w_i \otimes \dots \otimes w_k$$

provides a distinct linearly independent vector in $\mathrm{im}(N)$, a contradiction.

Finally, since the action of $\mathfrak{h}_j$ on W_j is forced to be given by characters, it factors through the Abelianization $\mathfrak{h}_j/[\mathfrak{h}_j, \mathfrak{h}_j]$. But $\mathfrak{h}_j$ is simple, so that this is the trivial group. Hence only $\mathfrak{h}_i$ acts non-trivially on $W_1 \otimes \dots \otimes W_k$, as needed. $\square$

Thus we may write $\pi^*V_{\mathbb{C}} = (B_1 \otimes U_1) \oplus \dots \oplus (B_k \otimes U_k)$; however, this is only a decomposition of infinitesimal representations. Next, we will show that the $B_i \otimes U_i$ are in fact representations of $S(\mathbb{C})$. To that end, write

$$\mathfrak{k}_i = \mathfrak{h}_1 \oplus \dots \oplus \widehat{\mathfrak{h}_i} \oplus \dots \oplus \mathfrak{h}_k;$$

this allows us to describe $B_i \otimes U_i$ as $\mathrm{Ann}(\mathfrak{k}_i)$. We now claim that for all $g \in S(\mathbb{C})$, $gB_i \otimes U_i = B_i \otimes U_i$. To see this, choose any $X \in \mathfrak{k}_i$ and $u_i \in B_i \otimes U_i$; by Lie theory,

$$0 = g.(X.u_i) = g \frac{d}{dt} \Big|_{t=0} e^{tX} g^{-1} g.u_i = (\mathrm{Ad}(g)X).(g.u_i).$$

But Ad is a continuous action of $S(\mathbb{C})$ a connected group on the discrete set of simple ideals of $\mathfrak{s}_{\mathbb{C}}$. Hence the action does not permute the simple ideals, so that $\mathrm{Ad}(g)\mathfrak{h}_i = \mathfrak{h}_i$, and analogously for $\mathfrak{k}_i$. This implies that $\mathrm{Ad}(g)X \in \mathfrak{k}_i$, so that $g.u_i \in \mathrm{Ann}(\mathfrak{k}_i) = B_i \otimes U_i$, as needed.

Now we claim that $\mathfrak{h}_1 = \dots = \mathfrak{h}_k$. Indeed, by [Var26], $V_{\mathbb{C}}$ is irreducible, so by Clifford’s theorem [Cli37], Γ permutes the $B_i \otimes U_i$ factors transitively, i.e. $(B_i \otimes U_i)^\gamma = B_j \otimes U_j$, for all $\gamma \in \Gamma$. But recall that $U_i = \mathrm{Ann}(\mathfrak{k}_i)$, so conjugation by γ induces an outer isomorphism $\mathfrak{k}_i = \mathfrak{k}_j$, forcing $\mathfrak{h}_i = \mathfrak{h}_j$, as needed.

Finally, we claim that $B_i = \mathbb{C}$ for all i . Indeed, $V_{\mathbb{C}}$ varies maximally, so $\pi^*V_{\mathbb{C}}$ also varies maximally, meaning that no power of a Hodge structure shows up in the very general fiber. This shows that $\pi^*V_{\mathbb{C}} = U_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus U_k$, as needed. $\square$

Notice that $S(\mathbb{C})$ is still merely isogenous to a power of a simple group. We lose no generality in taking H^k to be the universal cover of $S(\mathbb{C})$; thus $\pi^*V_{\mathbb{C}} = U_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus U_k$ acquires the structure of a H^k -representation. Furthermore, the i -th factor H_i acts non-trivially on U_i and trivially on U_j for $j \neq i$.

Proposition 4.7. *Let $G = \mathbf{MT}(V_{\mathbb{Q}})$ be the full Mumford–Tate group, and $\tilde{G}$ its universal cover, $\tilde{G} = Z \times H_1 \times \cdots \times H_k$. There exists an intermediate extension $G' \twoheadrightarrow G$ for which the Deligne torus $h : \mathbb{S} \rightarrow G$ lifts to $h' : \mathbb{S} \rightarrow G'$. Furthermore, we may write G' as a diagonal quotient*

$$M' = \tilde{G}/(\underline{\zeta}) = \frac{Z \times H_1 \times \cdots \times H_k}{(\zeta_0, \zeta_1, \dots, \zeta_k)}$$

for $\zeta_0 \in Z$ and $\zeta_i \in Z(H_i)$.

Proof. In order for the Deligne torus to lift to an intermediate cover $G' \rightarrow G$, we must have $h' : \mathbb{S} \rightarrow G'$ acting by a torus representation on U_i . In other words, $dh' = X_0 + X_1 + \cdots + X_k$ must have integer eigenvalues. This is the same as requiring $\exp(2\pi i \cdot dh') = 1 \in G'$. Thus we define $\zeta_i = \exp(2\pi i X_i)$, $i = 0, \dots, k$, and take $\underline{\zeta} = (\zeta_0, \zeta_1, \dots, \zeta_k) \in \tilde{G}(\mathbb{C})$. By construction, the Deligne torus will lift to $G' = \tilde{G}/\underline{\zeta}$. $\square$

To better understand why we generally cannot lift the Deligne torus to the universal cover $\tilde{G}$, consider the following example.

Example 4.8. Suppose $G = \mathrm{GL}_2 \times_{\mathbb{G}_m} \mathrm{GL}_2$, acting on $U_1 \oplus U_2$ by the standard representation. Then $\tilde{G}(\mathbb{C}) = \mathbb{G}_m(\mathbb{C}) \times \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{C})^2$. We can decompose the Hodge co-character as

$$\mu = \begin{pmatrix} z & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & z & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad d\mu = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} = X_0 + X_1 + X_2.$$

Write the trace $\mathrm{Tr}(X|_{U_1}) = \mathrm{Tr}((X_0 + X_1)|_{U_1}) = \mathrm{Tr}(X_0|_{U_1}) = 1$. But X_0 is central, so it is diagonal and acts by multiplication by $1/2$. Consequently,

$$X_0 = \begin{pmatrix} 1/2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1/2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1/2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1/2 \end{pmatrix}, \quad X_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1/2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -1/2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad X_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1/2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & -1/2 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Now if we exponentiate these generators, we get

$$\zeta_0 = -1 \in \mathbb{G}_m, \quad \zeta_1 = \zeta_2 = -I_2 \in Z(\mathrm{SL}_2).$$

Notice that $G' = \tilde{G}/(\underline{\zeta}) = G$, so the Deligne torus lifts no further than G . $\square$

Now take the derived subgroup of G' :

$$G' = [\tilde{G}/N, \tilde{G}/N] = \frac{[\tilde{G}, \tilde{G}]N}{N} = \frac{[\tilde{G}, \tilde{G}]}{[\tilde{G}, \tilde{G}] \cap N},$$

where $N = \langle \zeta \rangle$. Notice that all the ζ_i are central, so that the intersection $[\tilde{G}, \tilde{G}] \cap N$ is trivial. Since $[\tilde{G}, \tilde{G}] = H_1 \times \cdots \times H_k$, we get the following corollary.

Corollary 4.9. *Let $U'_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus U'_k$ be the induced representation of G' on $\pi^*V_{\mathbb{C}} = U_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus U_k$. The derived subgroup $[G', G'] = H_1 \times \cdots \times H_k$ is a power of a simple group, and acts on $U'_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus U'_k$ with each H_i acting non-trivially on U'_i and trivially on U'_j for $j \neq i$.*

4.3. Proof of the main theorem. Now we are ready to prove the main theorem.

Theorem 4.10. *Let X be a primitive symplectic variety of dimension $2g$, and let $f : X \rightarrow B$ be a Lagrangian fibration. Let G be the derived Mumford–Tate group of f .*

$$(4.1) \quad G = \begin{cases} \mathrm{Sp}_{2g/k}^k & : f \text{ varies maximally,} \\ \mathrm{SL}_2 & : f \text{ is isotrivial with Hodge-generic fiber,} \\ 1 & : f \text{ is isotrivial with CM fiber.} \end{cases}$$

Proof. As before, take $\pi : B' \rightarrow B$ be the cover over which $\pi^*V = U_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus U_k$ splits, and let Γ be the automorphism group of the cover, acting transitively on the U_i . We claim that each of the U_i is isotypic, i.e. $U_i \not\cong U_j$ for $i \neq j$. To see that this holds, suppose that $U_1 \cong U_2$. By Proposition 4.1, there exists a component D_1 of the discriminant which has non-finite local monodromy. Without loss of generality, suppose that U_1 degenerates along D_1 . Then U_2 also degenerates along D_1 . But by Lemma 3.1, every general degeneration is of nilpotent rank one, a contradiction.

Hence we must have $U_i \not\cong U_j$ for $i \neq j$. We now claim that the splitting is defined over $\mathbb{Q}$. Indeed, the splitting occurs over some number field K , so we have a $\mathbb{Q}$ -irreducible factor $W \subseteq V_{\mathbb{Q}}$ which splits as $W_K = U_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus U_{\ell}$. But now the Galois group $\mathrm{Gal}(K/\mathbb{Q})$ transitively permutes the $U_1, \dots, U_{\ell}$. Now as above, suppose U_1 degenerates over $D_1 \subseteq D$. The limit variation of mixed Hodge structures of V over D_1 is defined over $\mathbb{Q}$, while that of U_1 is not; thus any element of the Galois orbit of U_1 must degenerate over D_1 like U_1 . But by Lemma 3.1, at most one of the U_1 can degenerate, forcing $\ell = 1$, and therefore $K = \mathbb{Q}$.

Now any irreducible factor of G is defined over $\mathbb{Q}$. Set $U = U_1$ and $H = H_1$, and consider the action of H on U . The group H is geometrically simple, so that $H(\mathbb{C})$ is one of $\mathrm{SL}_{2h}(\mathbb{C})$, $\mathrm{Sp}_{2h}(\mathbb{C})$, or $\mathrm{SO}_{2h}(\mathbb{C})$. However, we may rule out $\mathrm{SL}_{2h}(\mathbb{C})$ and $\mathrm{SO}_{2h}(\mathbb{C})$, since U comes from a family of Abelian varieties of dimension h .

Recall that $\mathrm{Sp}_{2h}(\mathbb{C})$ has no non-trivial outer automorphisms. Thus H is an inner form of Sp_{2h} . Since U comes from a family of Abelian varieties (up to isogeny), $H(\mathbb{R}) = \mathrm{Sp}_{2h}(\mathbb{R})$; the only alternative would be $\mathrm{Sp}(p, q)$, which is non-Hermitian when $q \neq 0$, for which U is isotrivial. Now H must be of the form $\mathrm{Sp}_r(\mathbf{D})$, for $\mathbf{D}$ a division algebra with center $\mathbb{Q}$, so that the fibers of U have the form $U_b = \mathbf{D}^r$. Maximal parabolic subgroups of H are in bijection with totally isotropic $\mathbf{D}$ -subspaces $W \subseteq U_b$ via orbit–stabilizer. In particular, since $\dim_{\mathbb{Q}} \mathbf{D} = d > 1$, the rank of the local monodromy logarithm of U around D_1 is at least d , contradicting Lemma 3.1. Therefore $H = \mathrm{Sp}_{2h}$, and $G = \mathrm{Sp}_{2h}^k$, concluding the proof. $\square$

Note that this allows us to compute the center of the special Mumford–Tate group. Since special endomorphisms are ruled out, the only endomorphisms which can commute with the special Mumford–Tate group are rational scalars. If we take c to be such a scalar, it satisfies

$$c^2 \psi(v, w) = \psi(cI_g.v, cI_g.w) = \psi(v, w),$$

with respect to the polarization ψ , forcing $c^2 = 1$ and $c = \pm 1$. However, since the special Mumford–Tate group is generated by the derived Mumford–Tate group and the identity component of the center, it is forced to be equal to G . This allows us to easily compute the actual Mumford–Tate group.

Corollary 4.11. *Let X be a primitive symplectic variety of dimension $2g$, and let $f : X \rightarrow B$ be a Lagrangian fibration. Let $\tilde{G}$ be the Mumford–Tate group of f .*

$$(4.2) \quad \tilde{G} = \begin{cases} (\mathbb{G}_m \times \mathrm{Sp}_{2g/k}^k)/\{\pm 1\} & : f \text{ varies maximally,} \\ \mathrm{GL}_2 & : f \text{ is isotrivial with Hodge-generic fiber,} \\ \mathbb{G}_m & : f \text{ is isotrivial with CM fiber.} \end{cases}$$

5. THE MUMFORD–TATE GROUP OF A GENERAL DEFORMATION

5.1. Degenerations of elliptic fibrations. Below, we compute several examples for the monodromy eigenvalues of a family of elliptic curves $f_S : S \rightarrow U$. None of this work is original, but it will serve as a useful example for understanding the main theorem below.

Example 5.1 (Type II). We work with the local model $y^2 = x^3 + t$. As t goes to $e^{2\pi i}t$, x goes to $e^{2\pi i/3}x$ and y goes to $e^{\pi i}y = -y$. Recall that F^1V is generated by dx/y ; as we have seen above, $T : dx/y \mapsto e^{-2\pi i}dx/y$. In other words, with respect to the Hodge frame, T takes the form

$$T = \begin{pmatrix} e^{-2\pi i/3} & 0 \\ 0 & e^{2\pi i/3} \end{pmatrix}.$$

□

Example 5.2 (Type II*). This time our local model is $y^2 = x^3 + t^5$. If we proceed as above, we will find that the monodromy acts trivially. Thus, we must first pass to a finite cover. Let $\Delta_u \rightarrow \Delta_t, u \mapsto u^6 = t$. By pulling back along this cover, we get $y^2 = x^3 + u^{30}$; define new coordinates for the total space via $x = x_u \cdot u^{10}$ and $y = y_u \cdot u^{15}$; we get a new defining equation

$$y_u^2 = x_u^3 + 1.$$

Thus we have trivialized the family. Pulling back dx/y , we get $u^{10}dx_u/u^{15}y_u = dx_u/u^5y_u$. Now consider what happens when we apply the monodromy operator on Δ_t^* . As t goes to $e^{2\pi i}t$, u goes to $e^{\pi i/3}u$. Thus, the action of T on the F^1 piece of the Hodge filtration is

$$\frac{dx_u}{u^5y_u} \mapsto \frac{dx_u}{e^{5\pi i/3}u^5y_u} = e^{\pi i/3} \frac{dx_u}{u^5y_u}.$$

In other words, T diagonalizes as

$$T = \begin{pmatrix} e^{\pi i/3} & 0 \\ 0 & e^{-\pi i/3} \end{pmatrix}.$$

□

By working out the remaining cases in Kodaira’s classification of minimal elliptic surfaces, one can deduce the following result.

Lemma 5.3. *If $S \rightarrow U$ is isotrivial of Kodaira type $I_n, I_n^*, II^*, III^*,$ or IV^* , the eigenvalue of F^1 (viewed as an eigenspace) lies in the upper half-plane.*

5.2. Splitting the fibration via the Mumford–Tate group. Let G be the Mumford–Tate group of a Lagrangian fibration $f : X \rightarrow B$. We have shown above that there exists a (ramified) cover $\pi : B' \rightarrow B$ such that $\pi^*V_{\mathbb{C}} = U_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus U_k$, and $G(\mathbb{C})$ is isogenous to $H(\mathbb{C})^k$, for $H(\mathbb{C})$ a connected algebraic group acting on the U_i .

Consider the isomorphism $\mathcal{T}_B \xrightarrow{\sim} F^1\overline{\mathcal{V}}$. We want to lift this to an isomorphism on the cover $\mathcal{T}_{B'} \xrightarrow{\sim} F^1\overline{\pi^*\mathcal{V}}$. Equivalently, we would need the symplectic form on $\overline{\mathcal{V}}$ to lift to a symplectic form on $\overline{\pi^*\mathcal{V}}$. It is enough to check this locally: set Δ_t^* to be a cross-section of a tubular neighborhood of $D \subseteq B$, and set Δ_s^* to be an analogous cross-section upstairs, $\pi : \Delta_s^* \rightarrow \Delta_t^*, s \mapsto s^r = t$. Recall that $V = W \oplus E$, where W is trivial and E captures all of the degeneration of f . We have the commutative square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} F^1\overline{\pi^*\mathcal{E}}_{\Delta_s} & \xrightarrow{\delta} & \pi^*F^1\overline{\mathcal{E}}_{\Delta_t} \\ \iota_{\sigma'} \uparrow & & \simeq \uparrow \\ \mathcal{T}_{\Delta_s} & \xrightarrow{d\pi} & \pi^*\mathcal{T}_{\Delta_t} \end{array}$$

Suppose that E is isotrivial. Then the limit mixed Hodge structure of E is simply the general fiber of E , and T is a Hodge endomorphism. In particular, the Deligne frame is a T -eigenbasis, i.e.

$$\tilde{e}_j = \exp\left(2\pi i \log\left(\frac{t}{2\pi i}\right) N\right) e_j = e^{2\pi i \alpha_j \log \frac{t}{2\pi i}} e_j = \frac{1}{2\pi i} t^{2\pi i \alpha_j} e_j.$$

Suppose that the cover π resolves the local monodromy. Then the frame $1 \otimes e_i$ is a Deligne frame on Δ_s . Writing the morphism δ in terms of the new Deligne frames,

$$\begin{aligned} \delta : \tilde{e}'_1 &= 1 \otimes \pi^{-1}e_1 \mapsto 1 \otimes t^{-2\pi i \alpha_1} \cdot t^{2\pi i \alpha_1} \pi^{-1}e_1 \\ &= s^{-2\pi i r \alpha_1} \otimes \tilde{e}_1 \\ &= s^{2\pi i(-r\alpha_1-r+1)} \cdot s^{2\pi i(r-1)} \otimes \tilde{e}_1. \end{aligned}$$

On the other hand, we may consider the map $d\pi : \mathcal{T}_{\Delta_s} \rightarrow \pi^*\mathcal{T}_{\Delta_t}$. In terms of coordinates,

$$d(s^{2\pi i}) \mapsto d(t^{2\pi i}) = 2\pi i r \cdot s^{2\pi i(r-1)} \otimes d(t^{2\pi i/r})$$

In particular, δ drops rank in the same degree as $d\pi$ precisely when $r\alpha_1 = 1 - r$, and $\alpha = 1/r - 1$. Equivalently, the F^1 eigenvalue lies in the upper half-plane. On the other hand, if $\alpha_1 = -1/r$, the rank drop of δ is degree one.

More generally, if E is possibly non-isotrivial with trivial unipotent rank, we can still consider the frame $\tilde{e}_j$. While T is no longer diagonalized by the Deligne frame, it is diagonal on the limit mixed Hodge structure on the puncture. The computation above yields the nilpotent residues of the connection. (***)

Set E to have monodromy matrix

$$T = \begin{pmatrix} e^{2\pi i \alpha_1} & 0 \\ 0 & e^{2\pi i \alpha_2} \end{pmatrix}.$$

We get a Deligne frame

$$\tilde{e}_i = \exp\left(2\pi i \log\left(\frac{t}{2\pi i}\right) \begin{pmatrix} \alpha_1 & 0 \\ 0 & \alpha_2 \end{pmatrix}\right) e_i = \bar{t}^{\alpha_i} e_i,$$

where $\bar{t} := (t/2\pi i)^{2\pi i}$. On Δ_s , we get an induced Deligne frame

$$\tilde{e}'_i = 1 \otimes \pi^{-1} e_i,$$

whose simple form comes from the fact that π resolves T . However, we must remark that neither of these frames needs to be a Hodge frame away from $t = 0$ and $s = 0$. By the argument above, we may find holomorphic functions g, g' on Δ_t and Δ_s respectively such that

$$h_1 = \tilde{e}_1 + g\tilde{e}_2 = \bar{t}^{\alpha_1} e_1 + g\bar{t}^{\alpha_2} e_2$$

generates $F^1 \bar{\mathcal{E}}$ and

$$h'_1 = \tilde{e}'_1 + g'\tilde{e}'_2 = 1 \otimes \pi^{-1} e_1 + g' \otimes \pi^{-1} e_2$$

generates $F^1 \pi^* \bar{\mathcal{E}}$. Now we may consider the comparison morphism δ as above. Recall that $\alpha_2 = -1 - \alpha_1$.

$$\begin{aligned} \delta : h'_1 &\mapsto 1 \otimes \pi^{-1} e_1 + g' \otimes \pi^{-1} e_2 = \\ &= \bar{s}^{-r\alpha_1} \otimes \bar{t}^{\alpha_1} \pi^{-1} e_1 + g' \bar{s}^{-r\alpha_2} \otimes \bar{t}^{\alpha_2} \pi^{-1} e_2 \\ &= \bar{s}^{-r\alpha_1} \left(1 \otimes \pi^{-1} \tilde{e}_1 + g' \bar{s}^{r+2r\alpha_1} \otimes \pi^{-1} \tilde{e}_2 \right) \\ &= \bar{s}^{-r\alpha_1} \otimes \pi^{-1} h_1 - (\bar{s}^{-r\alpha_1} \otimes g\bar{t}^{-1-\alpha_1} - g' \bar{s}^{r+r\alpha_1} \otimes 1) \cdot 1 \otimes \pi^{-1} \tilde{e}_2 \\ &= \bar{s}^{-r\alpha_1} \otimes \pi^{-1} h_1 - (\bar{s}^{-r-2r\alpha_1} \otimes g - g' \bar{s}^{r+r\alpha_1} \otimes 1) \cdot 1 \otimes \pi^{-1} \tilde{e}_2 \end{aligned}$$

Observe that if $\alpha_1 = -d/r$, as s approaches zero, $\bar{s}^{-r\alpha_1} = o(|s|^d)$, while $\bar{s}^{-r-2r\alpha_1} \otimes g = o(|\bar{s}|^{2d})$ and $g' \bar{s}^{r+r\alpha_1} = o(|\bar{s}|^r)$ (**). In particular, δ drops rank with degree d , reducing to the case above.

Now suppose instead that E has non-trivial unipotent part,

$$T = \begin{pmatrix} e^\alpha & 1 \\ 0 & e^\alpha \end{pmatrix}, \quad e^\alpha = \pm 1.$$

We work with the Deligne frame above: on Δ_t ,

$$\tilde{e}_1 = \exp \left(2\pi i \log \left(\frac{t}{2\pi i} \right) N \right) e_1 = \left(\frac{t}{2\pi i} \right)^{2\pi i \alpha} e_1,$$

and

$$\tilde{e}_2 = \exp \left(2\pi i \log \left(\frac{t}{2\pi i} \right) N \right) e_2 = \left(\frac{t}{2\pi i} \right)^{2\pi i \alpha} e_2 + 2\pi i \log \left(\frac{t}{2\pi i} \right) \cdot \left(\frac{t}{2\pi i} \right)^{2\pi i \alpha} e_1.$$

In the limit mixed Hodge structure, the F^1 is spanned by $\tilde{e}_2$. However, this is not by itself a Hodge frame over Δ_t^* . Instead, we may write $h_2 = \tilde{e}_2 + g_1 \tilde{e}_1$, for g_1 a function holomorphic on Δ_t and vanishing at $t = 0$, with h_2 spanning F^1 .

Write the analogous Deligne frame $\tilde{e}'_i$ and Hodge frame h'_i for Δ_s , with $\alpha' = 0$. For simplicity, we will substitute

$$\bar{t} = \left(\frac{t}{2\pi i} \right)^{2\pi i}, \quad \bar{s} = \left(\frac{s}{2\pi i} \right)^{2\pi i}.$$

The map

$$\begin{aligned} \delta : h'_2 &= \bar{s} \otimes e_2 + (\bar{s} \log(\bar{s}) + g'_1) \otimes e_1 \mapsto (\bar{s})^r \otimes e_2 + (r(\bar{s})^r \log(\bar{s}) + g'_1) \otimes e_1 \\ &= (\bar{s})^{r(1-\alpha)} \otimes (\bar{t})^\alpha e_2 + (\bar{s})^{r(1-\alpha)} \otimes ((\bar{t})^\alpha \log(\bar{t}) + g_1) e_1 + \\ &\quad + (g'_1 \otimes 1 - (\bar{s})^{r(1-\alpha)} \otimes g_1) e_1 \\ &= (\bar{s})^{r(1-\alpha)} \otimes h_2 + (g'_1 \otimes 1 - (\bar{s})^{r(1-\alpha)} \otimes g_1) e_1 \end{aligned}$$

The right term vanishes as $s \rightarrow 0$. Now if $\alpha = -1/2$, setting $r = 2$ allows δ to attain the same drop of rank as $d\pi$. Otherwise, if $\alpha = 0$, T does not permute the U_i , and thus the acquired singular fibers come from the fibration downstairs.

Theorem 5.4. *Suppose that for every dimension $g - 1$ component of the discriminant $D_1 \subseteq D \subseteq B$, the general singular fiber of $\mathcal{E}|_{D_1} \rightarrow D_1$ is not of Kodaira type II, III, or IV. Then the morphism $\iota_{\sigma'} : \mathcal{T}_{B'} \rightarrow F^1 \pi^* \mathcal{V}$ is an isomorphism on the smooth locus of B' .*

Proof. This follows from the preceeding discussion on the singular fibers of elliptic fibrations and the fact that δ captures all of the drop in rank of the derivative map $d\pi$. (May need to use relative MMP for elliptic fibrations***) $\square$

We illustrate this with the following example.

Example 5.5. Let $f : S \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^1$ be the elliptically fibered K3 surface defined by the following Weirstrass equation: $y^2 = x^3 + t^4 x + t^5(t^2 + 1)$, for t a coordinate on $\mathbb{P}^1$. This has discriminant with defining equation

$$\Delta(t) = 4(t^4)^3 + 27(t^7 + t^5)^2 = 27t^{14} + 58t^{12} + 27t^{10}.$$

Note that $\Delta(t)$ vanishes to order 10 at 0 and ∞ , and has simple zeros at the roots of $27t^4 + 58t^2 + 27$. In particular, the Euler characteristic of the total space S is $\chi(S) = 10 + 10 + 4 \cdot 1 = 24$, as needed. By Kodaira's classification of singular fibers, the fibers over 0 and ∞ are of type II^* , while the four simple fibers are of type I_1 .

Let $\pi : B' \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^1$ be a degree six cover branched at 0 and ∞ . By Riemann–Hurwitz, we have

$$\chi(B') - \deg R = \chi(B') - 2 = 6(\chi(\mathbb{P}^1) - 2) = 0.$$

Hence $\chi(B') = 2$, forcing $B' \simeq \mathbb{P}^1$.

Now consider the pullback of S :

$$\begin{array}{ccc} S' & \longrightarrow & S \\ \downarrow f' & & \downarrow f \\ \mathbb{P}^1 & \xrightarrow{\pi} & \mathbb{P}^1 \end{array}$$

We claim that the induced symplectic form on the smooth fibers of f' extends to a symplectic form on the singular fibers of f' . To see this, it suffices to show that S' is another K3 surface. We again check this by verifying the Euler characteristic of S' . Since S_0 and S_∞ have local monodromy $\mathbb{Z}/6\mathbb{Z}$, the cover resolves the monodromy group, thereby smoothing the II^* fibers. On the other hand, the four I_1 fibers are left untouched, so that

$$\chi(S') = \sum_{b \in D \setminus \{0, \infty\}} 6 \cdot \chi(S_b) = 24.$$

$\square$

5.3. The action of the component group. As above, let $\pi : B' \rightarrow B$ be the cover for which the algebraic monodromy group splits into a power of a simple group, and $\pi^*V_{\mathbb{C}} = \bigoplus_i U_i$. Let $D \subseteq B$ be the branch divisor of π , and $R \subseteq B'$ the ramification divisor.

The component group Γ transitively permutes the irreducible factors U_i . However, if $\gamma_{ij}, \gamma_{ji} \in \Gamma$ are such that $\gamma_{ij}U_i = U_j$ and $\gamma_{ji}U_j = U_i$, then $\gamma_{ji}\gamma_{ij}$ acts on U_i by a (possibly non-trivial) scalar. As such, there can a priori be more to the action of Γ than just the induced $\mathfrak{S}_k$ -action on the $\{U_1, \dots, U_k\}$.

Lemma 5.6. *Let $D = D_1 \cup \dots \cup D_r$ be the (codimension one) components of D , and let $\gamma_i \in \Gamma$ be the local monodromy operator corresponding to D_i . There exists an intermediate cover $B'' \rightarrow B$ on which $V_{\mathbb{C}}$ splits as before, for which the covering group is $\mathfrak{S}_k$ acting by permuting the irreducible summands.*

Proof. Denote by $\varphi : \Gamma \rightarrow \mathfrak{S}_k$ the induced permutation action on the U_i factors. Then $\ker \varphi$ is a normal subgroup stabilizing each summand. We handle the cases of $\gamma_i \in \ker \phi$ and $\gamma_i \notin \ker \phi$ separately.

First, suppose the latter. Then for some $a \neq b$ we have $\gamma_i U_a = U_b$. Since γ_i has finite order, there exists a minimal c for which $\gamma_i^c U_a = U_a$. Now take $u \in F^1 \overline{U}_a|_R$ in the limit mixed Hodge structure, and consider its orbit under γ_i :

$$u^{(j)} := \gamma_i^j \cdot u, \quad j = 0, 1, \dots, c-1.$$

Each of the $u^{(j)}$ lies in $F^1 \mathcal{U}_{b'}|_R$ for some $b' \neq a$. By Schur's lemma, $\gamma_i^c \cdot u = e^{2\pi i/n} u$ for some $n \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$, possibly 1.

Let ζ be any primitive $(c \cdot n)$ -th root of unity with $\zeta^c = e^{-2\pi i/n}$. We can take the sum

$$v_{\zeta} = u^{(0)} + \zeta u^{(1)} + \dots + \zeta^{c-1} u^{(c-1)}.$$

If we apply γ_i to v_{ζ} , we obtain

$$v_{\zeta} \mapsto \zeta^{c-1} \zeta^c u^{(0)} + u^{(1)} + \zeta u^{(2)} + \dots + \zeta^{c-2} u^{(c-1)} = \bar{\zeta} v_{\zeta}$$

Thus, we have produced a non-trivial eigenvector v_{ζ} for γ_i lying in $F^1 \mathcal{V}|_{D_i}$. Note that the same construction yields $v_{\bar{\zeta}}$ a second eigenvector in $F^1 \mathcal{V}|_{D_i}$, this time with eigenvalue ζ . By Lemma 3.1, we must have $\zeta = \bar{\zeta}$, so that $\zeta = -1$. In particular, $c = 2$ and $n = 1$. Now that the only non-trivial eigenspaces of γ_i are accounted for, we see that γ_i is forced to be a transposition:

$$\gamma_i U_a = U_b, \quad \gamma_i^2 = 1, \quad \gamma_i|_{U_j} = 1 \text{ if } j \neq a, b.$$

To deal with the case where $\gamma_i \in \ker \varphi$, we may need to replace π with an intermediate cover. By the argument above, Γ surjects onto $\mathfrak{S}_k$. Hence, the composition $\pi_1(B^\circ, b) \rightarrow G \rightarrow \Gamma \rightarrow \mathfrak{S}_k$ is also surjective. Let $B' \rightarrow B'' \xrightarrow{p} B$ be the corresponding intermediate Galois cover. By construction, the splitting $p^*V_{\mathbb{C}} = U_1 \oplus \dots \oplus U_k$ exists on the intermediate cover.

Where before we had an exact sequence

$$1 \rightarrow \mathrm{Sp}_{2h}^k \rightarrow \mathrm{Mon}(V_{\mathbb{Q}}) \rightarrow \Gamma \rightarrow 1,$$

we now have a slightly different exact sequence given by

$$1 \rightarrow \mathrm{Sp}_{2h}^k \cdot \ker(\varphi) \rightarrow \mathrm{Mon}(V_{\mathbb{Q}}) \rightarrow \mathfrak{S}_k \rightarrow 1.$$

The group $\ker \varphi$ is a finite group, which acts on $V_{\mathbb{C}}$ by inner automorphisms, i.e. its representation factors through $\mathrm{PSp}_{2h}(\mathbb{C})$. If we find a way to prove that the local monodromy operators

in $\ker \varphi$ act with monodromy eigenvalues ± 1 (or even lying in the upper half-plane), we will not need to pass to the intermediate cover. $\square$

5.4. Proving Hodge-genericity. Recall that we had $\pi : B' \rightarrow B$ such that $\pi^*V = U_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus U_k$, a splitting we now know to occur over $\mathbb{Q}$. Let

$$1 \rightarrow \Gamma' \rightarrow \Gamma \rightarrow \Lambda \rightarrow 1$$

be the corresponding map of monodromy groups, where Γ is the monodromy image of V , Γ' is the monodromy image of π^*V , and Λ is the covering automorphisms of π .

Recall again that $V_{\mathbb{C}}$ is irreducible as a $\mathbb{C}$ -local system, by [Var26]. Since π^*V decomposes as above, the group Λ must transitively permute the irreducible factors U_i . Since Λ is a quotient of Γ , it is generated by local monodromy operators coming from some components $D_i \subseteq D$.

Lemma 5.7. *There exists a component of the discriminant $D_1 \subseteq D$ whose associated local monodromy operator λ acts by a two-cycle on the U_i factors:*

$$\lambda : U_i \rightarrow U_j, U_j \rightarrow U_i, U_\ell \xrightarrow{\sim} U_\ell, \quad \lambda^2 = \text{id}.$$

Proof. First notice that there is a natural map $\Lambda \rightarrow \mathfrak{S}_k$, coming from the permutations of the factors $U_1, \dots, U_k$ underlying the action of Λ . In fact, this proof will show that this map is surjective, but it suffices that it surjects onto a subgroup $\bar{\Lambda} \leq \mathfrak{S}_k$. Since Λ is the group of covering automorphisms of π , there is a corresponding intermediate cover

$$B' \xrightarrow{\pi'} B'' \xrightarrow{p} B$$

where $\bar{\Lambda} = \text{Aut}(p)$. Take D_1 to be a component whose local monodromy operator acts by an element of $\bar{\Lambda}$; then λ acts on any U_i by a c_i -cycle, i.e.

$$(5.1) \quad \lambda : U_i \rightarrow U_{i_2} \rightarrow \cdots \rightarrow U_{i_{c_i-1}} \rightarrow U_i, \quad \lambda^c : U_i \xrightarrow{\sim} U_i.$$

$\square$

Let Γ be the automorphism group of the cover, acting transitively on the summands. We want to realize $f : X \rightarrow B$ up to isogeny as a group quotient of a product fibration. For that, suppose $\Gamma \leq \mathfrak{S}_k$ is generated by a transitive collection of cycles of length $c \leq k$.

Let D be the branch locus of π . In a neighborhood of any component $D_1 \subseteq D$, we can choose coordinates $t_1, \dots, t_g$ on B and $s_1, \dots, s_g$ on B' such that t_1 vanishes along D_1 and $\pi : (s_1, \dots, s_g) \mapsto (s_1^c, s_2, \dots, s_g) = (t_1, \dots, t_g)$. Let $R = \pi^{-1}(D_1)$ be the ramification divisor of π , locally cut out by s_1 . Without loss of generality, replace B, B', R , and D with their respective analytic neighborhoods. Consider the following diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} F^1 \bar{\mathcal{U}}_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus F^1 \bar{\mathcal{U}}_k & \xrightarrow{\delta} & \pi^* F^1 \bar{\mathcal{V}} \\ \iota_\sigma \uparrow & & \simeq \uparrow \\ \mathcal{T}_{B'} & \xrightarrow{d\pi} & \pi^* \mathcal{T}_B \end{array}$$

Lemma 5.8. *The map δ vanishes to order $(c-1)$ along R .*

Proof. We follow the argument given in the preceding section. Let T be the local monodromy operator acting on $F^1 \bar{\mathcal{V}}$ along a loop in B around D . Let N be its logarithm; we have shown above that it has two non-trivial eigenvalues α_1 and $-1 - \alpha_1$, where α_1 is taken to be the

eigenvalue corresponding to the action on the F^1 piece of the limit mixed Hodge structure, chosen in the interval $(-1, 0]$.

We claim that $\alpha_1 = -1 - \alpha_1$; in particular, they are both $-1/2$. Suppose otherwise; let $u_1 \in F^1\mathcal{U}_1|_R$, and choose $u_i = T^{i-1}(u_1) \in F^1\mathcal{U}_i|_R$ for $i = 2, \dots, c$. By construction, for ζ a primitive c -th root of unity,

$$T : u_1 + \zeta u_2 + \dots + \zeta^{c-1} u_c \mapsto \bar{\zeta}(u_1 + \zeta u_2 + \dots + \zeta^{c-1} u_c).$$

Notice that this does not depend on a choice of ζ . Hence $F^1\bar{\mathcal{V}}|_D$ contains the eigenspaces of ζ and $\bar{\zeta}$. But we have shown above that only one T -eigenspace is non-trivial in $F^1\bar{\mathcal{V}}|_D$, forcing $\zeta = -1$, as needed. $\square$

Proposition 5.9. *The map ι_σ is an isomorphism.*

Proof. The map $d\pi$ vanishes to order $c - 1$, and by the preceding result, all of the vanishing is captured by δ . The needed statement follows from the commutativity of the diagram. $\square$

Corollary 5.10. *The automorphism group Γ of the cover $\pi : B' \rightarrow B$ is generated by transpositions. In particular, $\Gamma = \mathfrak{S}_k$.*

Theorem 5.11. *Let $f : X \rightarrow B$ be a general member of a given deformation class of hyper-Kähler manifolds admitting a Lagrangian fibration (in the sense of Matsushita–Voisin***). Then the Mumford–Tate group of the very general fiber X_b is GSp_{2g} .*

Proof. Since isotrivial Lagrangian fibrations are not general in their deformation class (loc. cit KLM?***), we may assume without loss of generality that f varies maximally. Thus it suffices to show that the Mumford–Tate group is not a product of symplectic groups. The local monodromy action of the cover π consists of the two-cycle permuting two irreducible factors U_i, U_j . This corresponds to a general singular fiber of type I_0^* . By (loc. cit Sawon or Lehn***), a Lagrangian fibration whose general singular is non-reduced (e.g. of type I_0^*) may not occur as a general member of its deformation class. $\square$

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